Croup

Severity	Symptoms/Signs	Management
Mild	Seal like Barking cough	**Dexamethasone** PO 0.15 mg/kg Single dose.
Moderate	Seal like Barking cough Stridor Sternal recession at rest	**Dexamethasone** PO 0.15 mg/kg Single dose. OR **Prednisolone** PO 1mg/kg Single dose. OR **Neb Budesonide** 2mg Single dose.
Severe	Same as Moderate with Agitation and lethargy	**Call Ambulance** Give **Oxygen** Give:
Impeding respiratory failure **Westley Croup Severity Score** **Clinical Feature** / **Assigned Score** **Level of consciousness**: Normal, including sleep = 0; Disoriented = 5 **Cyanosis**: None = 0; With agitation = 4; At rest = 5 **Stridor**: None = 0; With agitation = 1; At rest = 2 **Air entry**: Normal = 0; Decreased = 1; Markedly decreased = 2 **Retractions**: None = 0; Mild = 1; Moderate = 2; Severe = 3 **Score** / **Severity** / **Description** / **Management** ≤ 2 / Mild / • Occasional barky cough • No stridor at rest • Mild or no retractions / • Home treatment (antipyretic, fluids, mist) • Outpatient: Single dose PO dexamethasone 3 to 7 / Moderate / • Frequent barky cough • Stridor at rest • Mild to moderate retractions • No or little distress or agitation / • Single dose PO dexamethasone • Nebulized epinephrine • Hospitalization not generally needed 8 to 11 / Severe / • Frequent barky cough • Stridor at rest • Marked retractions • significant distress and agitation / • Single dose PO/IM/IV dexamethasone • Repeated doses of nebulized epinephrine prn • Inpatient admission usually required • Improved after corticosteroid and nebulized epinephrine ≥ 12 / Impending respiratory failure / • Depressed level of consciousness • Stridor at rest • Severe retractions • Poor air entry • Cyanosis or pallor / • Single dose PO/IM/IV dexamethasone • Repeated doses of nebulized epinephrine prn • ICU admission usually required • May require intubation	Sternal/Intercostal recession Asynchronous chest wall & abdominal movement Fatigue Pallor or Cyanosis Decreased level of consciousness Tachycardia RR > 70 breath/min	**Dexamethasone** PO 0.15 mg/kg Single dose. OR **Prednisolone** PO 1mg/kg Single dose. OR **Neb Budesonide** 2mg Single dose.